

When the CEO Says "Count the Lines of Code"

A Case Study in Measurement, Metrics & Managing Complex Projects

Project Status

 **\$2,000,000** over budget

 **30 days** behind schedule

The CEO's "Solution"

"Starting tomorrow, we will measure the **Lines of Code** each developer writes per day to force them to work faster!"

 **Is this the right fix?**

Three Phases of Today's Discussion

We have 3 phases to unpack what's really going wrong, and how great **digital project managers think differently**.

1

Phase 1

The Measurement **Pitfalls**

Are "30 days late" and "Over budget" **Leading or Lagging indicators?** Why is "Lines of Code per day" an extremely dangerous metric?

2

Phase 2

The Delay Cycle & Leading Indicators

Draw the **Delay Cycle on the whiteboard**. If we could time-travel back 2 months, **what Leading Indicators** should we have tracked? (i.e., Coupled Architecture → queue...)

3

Phase 3

The 4 Diagnostic Questions

Instead of blaming developers, **a great Digital Project Manager asks 4 key questions** to fix the structure — not the people.

The 4 Diagnostic Questions

Bottlenecks

Where are the bottlenecks?

Dependencies

Where are the dependencies?

Complexity

Where is complexity increasing?

Feedback

Where is feedback slow?

Discussions

Two big questions to explore together. Think carefully before answering — the answers might surprise you.

Q1: Leading vs. Lagging & Measurement Pitfalls

Are "**30 days late**" and "**Over budget**" **Leading or Lagging indicators?** And why is the CEO's new metric so dangerous for the team and the project?

Q2: The Delay Cycle and Leading Indicators

Can you draw the **Delay Cycle**? What Leading Indicators could have warned us 2 months ago — before the damage was done?

 Take a few minutes to discuss with your group. There are no wrong answers, only deeper insights waiting to be uncovered.